New Zealand Rogaining Association (Inc) **13th April 2007**
http://www.rogaine.org.nz/

NZRA Newsletter − April 2007

Peggioh Merry-Go-Round (New Zealand Rogaining Championships)

The annual New Zealand Championship 24hr event was held on the 3rd and 4th March in Marlborough. The event site was at Rob Mowatt's woolshed inland from Ward. Alan Holdaway produced a challenging and enjoyable course with a significant amount of hill-climbing but which, fortunately, avoided the much steeper hill country to the North and Southwest (see the map on the NZRA website).

The weather was very kind, mostly warm and calm, but maybe a little too warm for a few hours on the first day. Most people continued all night in their light daytime clothing. Navigation was assisted by the brilliant moon that shone all night. A feature of the event was the on-course hashhouse which was really there as a safety outpost in the remote backcountry, but everyone agreed that being greeted there by a happy band of helpers and being served cheese toasties and soup in the middle of the night was a highlight of the event.

The overall and MO winners were Nathan Fa'avae and Richard Ussher (3630 points) with second place going to Chris Morrissey and George Christison (3490 points). Rachel Smith and Rhys Burns were third and first XO scoring 3160. An aspect worthy of note was the strong showing by mixed teams.

The other main place-getters were:

Emma De Lacey, Guy De Lacey	1st XV, 4th overall	2730 pts
Mike Sheridan, Chris Tait	1st MV, 5th overall	2700 pts
Ross Bidmead, Hazel Bidmead	1st Family, 7th overall	2600 pts
Peter Squires, Anne Kennedy, Bill Kennedy	1st XSV, 9th overall	2550 pts
Dave Laurie, Andy Buchanan, Phil Bones	1st MSV	2280 pts
Michael Nuttal, Tim Farrant	1st Junior	2270 pts
Brenda Lavin, Hannah McGregor	1st Women	2190 pts
Janet Wilson, Yvette Cottam	1st WV	1760 pts
Trish Faulkner, Kathrin Mueller	1st WSV	1600 pts

Complete results, including a checkpoint by checkpoint breakdown of each team's course courtesy of the Navlight electronic punching, are available on the website www.rogaine.org.nz. Also on the website is a map of the course, organiser's report, an interesting analysis on what it takes to win a Rogaine, and many pictures.

Annual General Meeting

The AGM was held on 20th February with Pete Squires in the Chair. The following people were elected as Officers:

President – Pete Squires
Secretary/Treasurer – Tom Barnfield (but please see below)
Committee – Andy Buchanan, Dave Laurie, Guy de Lacey, Jac Woudberg, Emma de Lacey, Phil Bones, Grant Hunter
Webmaster – Bill Kennedy
IRF Representative – Peter Squires
Regional reps – remain as for 2006.

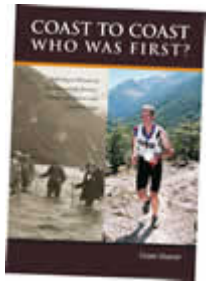
Of the wide range of issues discussed the following are of most interest:

1. A proposal to purchase a copy of OCAD9 mapping software was approved. This will enable us to produce better maps from digital data.
2. Management of the Navlight system – it was agreed that NZRA would become the manager of the equipment, delegating the task in the short term back to Pete Squires. The long term goal is for Pete to develop documentation and other support systems that will enable a committee member to manage this task. The completion date of support systems was set at Dec 2007. Emma de Lacey will take over the management task at this time.
3. A combined NZRA-NZOF bid to run the World Rogaining Champs (WRC) in New Zealand during the summer of 2009-2010 is likely to succeed. The initial planning team is Mark Copeland, Mike Sheridan, Pete Squires and Andy Buchanan. If the event goes ahead considerable assistance from other people will be required. The WRC is organised by a member country for the International Rogaining Federation (IRF) which provides a world-wide focus for Rogaining, website http://www.rogaining.com/ .

Tom Barnfield

It is with deep sorrow that we note the passing of Tom, our Secretary/Treasurer, on 7th March. Tom was one very fit guy who quite unexpectedly and without warning suffered a heart attack at the young age of 52. Tom approached his office of Secretary/Treasurer with the same application and gusto that he applied to all his outdoors activities. We will miss his pleasant demeanour and efficiency and we extend our condolences to Jude and the rest of the family.

Coast to Coast – Who was First?



NZRA member and rogaine organiser Grant Hunter has published a book **"Coast to Coast- Who was First?"**, released for the 25th anniversary event. Grant's story covers the Maori greenstone trails, the explorers and surveyors, and recreationalists from the 1890s through to **the** Coast to Coast. An order form is available from the NZRA website at http://www.rogaine.org.nz/main_files/NewsItems/

FUTURE EVENTS

The following events will be run in Canterbury, Marlborough, Wellington, and Auckland in the next couple of months. Access the details of each event via the website, www.rogaine.org.nz .

T'Walk 2007 (Canterbury) – 5th and 6th May

This will be the 41st T'walk (24 hour walk) organised by the University of Canterbury Tramping Club, the pioneer of long distance foot navigation events in NZ. T'walk differs from a rogaine in that teams follow fixed routes looping out for 5 to 8 hrs from the hash-house, but it is challenging, a lot of fun, and participants are well fed. For more detail and T'walk rules see http://www.cutc.org.nz/twalk/ .

Download an entry form from http://www.cutc.org.nz/twalk/twalk07_entryform.pdf

Wellington City Safari - Sunday 20th May

The City Safari allows you to use public transport instead of your legs to get partway to the checkpoints. This year the event starts in central Wellington. For more information see the event website www.citysafari.org.nz.

Marlborough Rogaine - Saturday 26th May

Organised by the Marlborough Orienteering Club, this rogaine will be a good warmup for the Heights of Winter. Event details will be available on the NZRA website shortly.

Queens Birthday Rogaine (Auckland) – Sunday 3rd June

In the Helensville area with some interesting mangrove swamp controls this event is a fundraiser for Neil's World Champs campaign. Organised by Neil Kerrison (neilkerrison@gmail.com), Ph 021 449 115.

Lactic Turkey Piha Rogaine (Auckland) – Saturday 9th June

See the Lactic Turkey Events website, http://www.lacticturkey.co.nz/ for more information and entry form.

Heights of Winter (Canterbury) – Saturday 16th June

This is a 12 hour event, with a 6hr option too, organised this year by PAPO and to be held in North Canterbury. Planning is well under way and details and an entry form are available on the NZRA website. Entries close 31st May.

OTHER EVENTS

Australian Championships – Saturday 28th and Sunday 29th July

This championship event, organised by the Northern Territory Rogaining Association in the Eastern MacDonnell Ranges near Alice Springs, is open to Kiwis. Information, entry form, and pictures are all available on the Northern Territory Rogaining Association website, http://nt.rogaine.asn.au/ . If you need an excuse to visit Central Oz this must be it. Contact is Jon Potter at spartacus@internode.on.net. Entries close 1st July.

With all these events coming up we hope to see you at one, or more, of them.

NZRA.